

6.3.5 Storage Limits

This is fast becoming a non-issue, but some providers do have tight limits (as low as 50 MB in some cases) on how much mail you can keep stored. In such a case, for example, using IMAP to keep your mail organised on the server would be futile; you'd need to keep deleting mail (or downloading them, as in POP3).

6.3.6 Backups

With a mail program using POP3, your mail is on your hard disk, nowhere else. So you should be in the habit of making backups at least once in a while. With Webmail, this isn't an issue—almost never have people lost mail online. With IMAP, it would depend on the storage limit—if it's large enough, it's like the situation with Webmail.

6.3.7 Privacy

Just remember that with Webmail, others could get at your mail if you don't sign out properly. Remember to uncheck the box that says "Remember me on this computer" (or something to that effect) if you're using a public computer.

6.3.8 The Cosmetics

People used to mail programs feel uncomfortable using Webmail; there's your mail, in the middle of the screen, and to the top and the bottom are ads, and to the left and right are other Web site elements. With a mail program (whether you're using IMAP or POP3), you have a neat window with just the text of the mail. It can feel more personal.

6.3.9 Do I Have A Choice?

At work, your mail program has probably been set up for you; it's unlikely that you'll have the choice of POP3 or IMAP. On the other hand, many ISPs offer you both. For example, Sify does. To find out if your ISP does, just Google "ISP_Name imap" and "ISP_Name pop3" and you'll have your answer! The settings for both (POP3 and IMAP) that you'll need to enter into your mail program for it to work will be on pages at your ISP's site; follow the instructions carefully.